Persia anyway, arguing that the current policy towards that country was contributing to anti-British feeling in the Muslim world that was making the Indian government's job that much harder. Hence, his reply to Montagu:

Unpleasant though Bolshevism up to our border would be, it is to us questionable whether it would be more dangerous than the present position when...British attitude in Persia is regarded in Moslem Asia, especially in Afghanistan and largely in Moslem India, as another example of Britain's crushing of Islam.[40]

As ever, pan-Islamism and Asian nationalism were of more concern to the Indian government than Bolshevism. Thus, the withdrawal of British troops from Persia was practically welcomed by the viceroy.

Together with the abrogation of the Anglo-Persian Agreement, Chelmsford no doubt hoped the removal of troops represented a change in Britain's Persian policy. Indeed, in January 1921 the Indian government made clear its intention to end its share of the maintenance of the South Persia Rifles (SPRs), effective at the end of March.[41] As the Indian government had been threatening since 1918 to bring its financial contributions to Persia to a close, this announcement regarding the SPRs should not have been a surprise to the Foreign Office. Nevertheless, it helps explain, in part, the animus displayed by Curzon towards the Indian government as expressed above. The foreign secretary was not the only one unhappy with this decision regarding the SPRs, however. In February 1921, the British financial adviser in Tehran, Sydney Armitage-Smith, composed a memorandum outlining his opinion on the Persian situation and arguing that the SPRs would now play a crucial role in that country following the withdrawal of Norperforce:

I am still not without hope that when the Government of India fully understands the hideous results of a complete abandonment of Persia and